

The Session 15 [informal] test produces a useful result. I selected [Approval of Jeff Skilling's Expense Report](E:\AAll XPlain\Dossier Space Pilot\ENRON Data Set Test 1\enron_mail_20150507\maildir\lay-k\discussion_threads\10..eml), dated 19 August 1999.

Diplomatics exposed several things that ordinary search or RAG might overlook:

- **The writer was not the approver.** Rosalee Fleming wrote and sent the email, but Kenneth Lay was identified as performing the approval.
- **The email was not necessarily the approval itself.** It was a notification asserting that an approval had occurred. The actual approval may have been embodied in the missing expense report.
- **The record had a business function.** It communicated authorization to the expense-processing function so that an administrative procedure could continue.
- **Different persons occupied different roles.** Fleming was the writer/originator, Lay the purported author of the approval act, the expense-report function the addressee, and Skilling the subject.
- **The evidence was incomplete.** The referenced attachment was absent, and there was no direct confirmation from Lay.
- **Authenticity and truth were separated.** The email may be an authentic Enron communication without its statement about Lay's approval necessarily being proven true.

The key analytical result is:

The record reliably shows that Fleming communicated an approval, but it does not by itself prove that Lay performed the approval.

That distinction—between the existence of a record, the act it reports, and the truth of its content—is what diplomatics added.

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Diplomatic analysis

1. Who?

Rosalee Fleming created and transmitted the email from her Enron account. The operational addressee was Enron's expense-report function. Kenneth Lay

is identified as the person who performed the approval, while Jeff Skilling is the subject of the expense report.

2. **What?**

The message records and communicates an alleged **approval act**: “Kenneth Lay has approved the attached expense report for Jeff Skilling.” The email is not necessarily the approval itself; it is evidence asserting that Lay had approved another record.

3. **Why?**

Its apparent business function was to notify the expense-processing function that the report had received the required executive authorization, allowing the administrative process to continue.

4. **When and where?**

The message is dated 19 August 1999 and is preserved under Lay’s Discussion threads folder. Its metadata associates it with the LAY-K collection and the source file klay.nsf, indicating that it entered the dataset through Lay’s account or archival email store.

5. **Trustworthiness?**

Several features support its plausibility:

- Enron-domain sender and recipient addresses.
- A unique Message-ID.
- Internal folder, origin, and source-file metadata.
- Similar messages from Fleming documenting Lay’s approval of other expense reports.

However, the email says an expense report was attached, while this EML contains only plain text and no attachment. It also contains no reply, approval signature, or independent confirmation from Lay. The surviving record therefore supports the proposition that **Fleming communicated that Lay had approved the report**, but does not independently prove that Lay actually examined or approved it.

Finding

This is plausibly an authentic Enron administrative communication created by Rosalee Fleming to notify the expense-report function of Kenneth Lay’s purported approval of Jeff Skilling’s expense report. Its form and surrounding procedural pattern support that interpretation, but the missing attachment and absence of direct corroboration prevent the underlying approval act from being treated as conclusively established.

Confidence: moderate for the email’s identity and business function; low-to-moderate for the underlying approval act.

The test adds analytical value because it exposes a distinction a RAG summary could easily miss: **the sender of the email, the person attributed with the act, and the subject of the transaction are three different diplomatic roles**. It also identifies the missing attachment as a material evidentiary gap.

File SHA-256:

3AC1944BB8FD593399C7D46096B368DDD8AF61DA79855D6C108FFD604ABFE001.